Palestinian conflict. In 2014, the pollsters found that a surprising 38 per cent of Americans supported imposing economic sanctions on Israel over its illegal settlements. Two years later, the number jumped to 46 per cent. Within those figures was a striking partisan gap: Democratic support for sanctions jumped by a quarter, from 48 per cent to 60 per cent, while Republican support stayed flat: 32 per cent in 2014, and 31 per cent in 2016. Similarly, the number of Democrats who thought Israel had too much influence on US policy rose from 49 per cent in 2015 to 55 per cent the following year. The number of Republicans who felt that way actually dipped, from 25 per cent to 22 per cent.

“There’s been a change in the Democratic party, and it goes beyond Obama, or this administration. They’re demographic changes,” said Zalman Shoval, a former Israeli ambassador in Washington. “And we really should take this into account.”

It’s not hard to see why. Netanyahu went to war against Obama’s signature foreign policy initiative, the Iran deal, and renounced the two-state solution. His government has done little to address the pet issues of many American Jews, like the Western Wall or Israel’s refusal to accept many foreign conversions to Judaism. (In one of 2016’s more extraordinary moments, a rabbinical court ruled that Ivanka Trump, the future president’s daughter, was not really Jewish because her conversion was performed by an unapproved rabbi.) The Israeli ambassador in Washington, Ron Dermer, refuses to meet with groups to the left of AIPAC, like J Street. “Bibi is like that friend who only calls when he needs something,” quipped one of the rabbis at the Jerusalem conference.

“Suddenly we were expecting the Jewish community to become Republicans,” said Meir. “The government of Israel talks to Republicans. It almost doesn’t have any dialogue with the Democratic party, and especially not with the liberal Jewish community.”

A few weeks after the election, Dermer was feted the Israeli ambassador in Washington, Ron Dermer, was feted at the Center for Security Policy, a far-right “think tank.” The group’s founder, Frank Gaffney, is a conspiracy theorist who believes that Obama is part of a secret Muslim Brotherhood plot to infiltrate the US government, a scheme that also involves anti-tax activist Grover Norquist. The proof for this, he believes, can be found in the new logo for the Pentagon’s missile defense agency, which features a